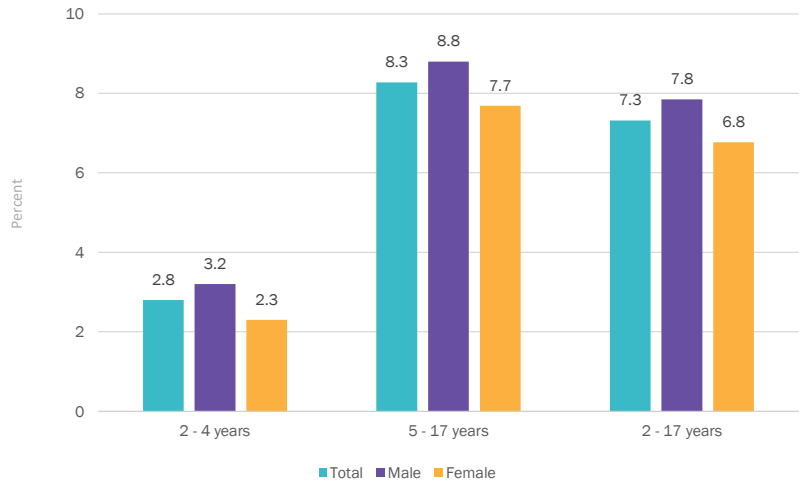
Bangladesh 2019

Child Functioning

Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys

Child Functioning: Levels & Domains

Child Functioning Levels by Age-Group



Percentage of children with functional difficulty in at least one domain by age-group

Children with disabilities are among the most marginalized groups in society. Facing daily discrimination in the form of negative attitudes, and lack of adequate policies and legislation, children with disabilities are effectively barred from realizing their rights to health, education, and even survival. Children with disabilities are often likely to be among the poorest members of the population and are less likely to attend school, access medical services, or have their voices heard in society. Discrimination against and exclusion of children with disabilities also puts them at a higher risk of physical and emotional abuse or other forms of neglect, violence and exploitation.

The Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNICEF, 1989) and the more recent Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UN, 2006) explicitly state the rights of children with disabilities on an equal basis with other children.

These Conventions focus on the disparities faced by children with disabilities and call for improvements in their access to services, and in their participation in all aspects of life. In order to achieve these goals, there is a need for cross-nationally comparable, reliable data.

Child Functioning Domains

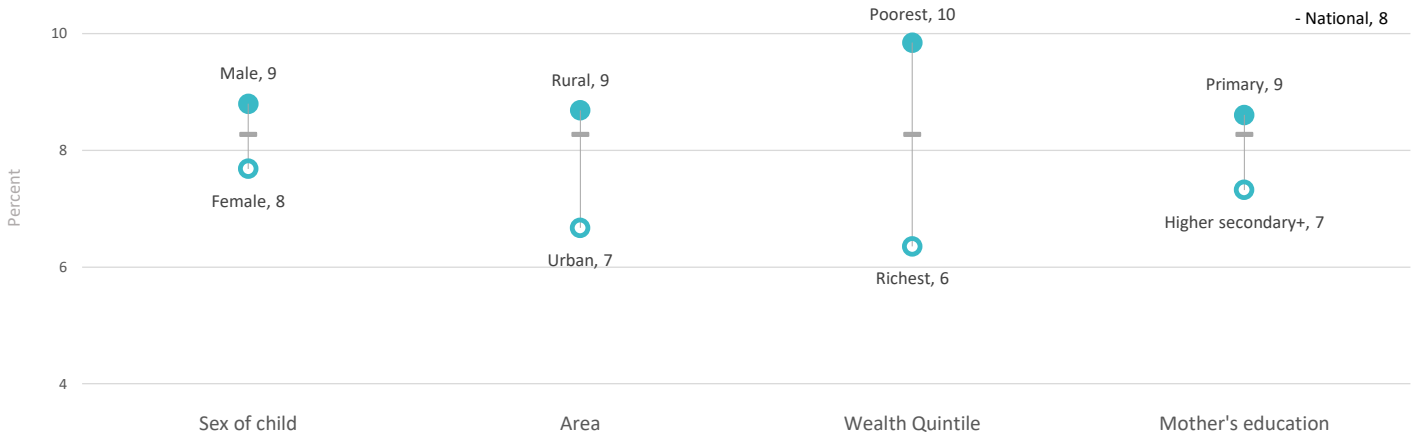
	Seeing	Hearing	Walking	Fine Motor	Communication	Learning	Playing	Controlling Behaviour	Self care	Remembering	Concentrating	Accepting Change	Making Friends	Anxiety	Depression
National															
2-4 years	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.3	0.7	1.2	0.5	1.1	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
5-17 years	0.3	0.3	0.9	N/A	0.6	1.6	N/A	2.2	1.0	1.7	0.9	1.3	0.6	3.2	3.7

Percentage of children age 2–17 years with functional difficulty in at least one domain, by domain of difficulty
N/A- Not Applicable

Key Messages

- About 7% of children aged 2-17 years had functional difficulty in at least one domain. Boys were more likely to have a functional difficulty than girls.
- The proportion of children with functional difficulties increases with age, from 3% at 2-4 years to 8% at 5-17 years.
- Depression and anxiety were the most common functional difficulties reported amongst children aged 5-17 (4% and 3%, respectively). High levels of depression and anxiety amongst children is a cause for concern.
- Disparities exist for functional difficulties reported for children. Children who live in rural areas and come from the poorest households are more likely to have functional difficulty in at least one domain. Children whose mothers received only primary education are also more likely to have a functional difficulty in at least one domain than children whose mothers received higher secondary education.
- Children in Barishal Division, in the south-central region of the country, have the highest rate of functional difficulties in all three age groups, followed by the Mymensingh division. The lowest proportion of children with functional difficulties recorded in Sylhet.

Child Functioning: Inequalities (lowest vs highest)



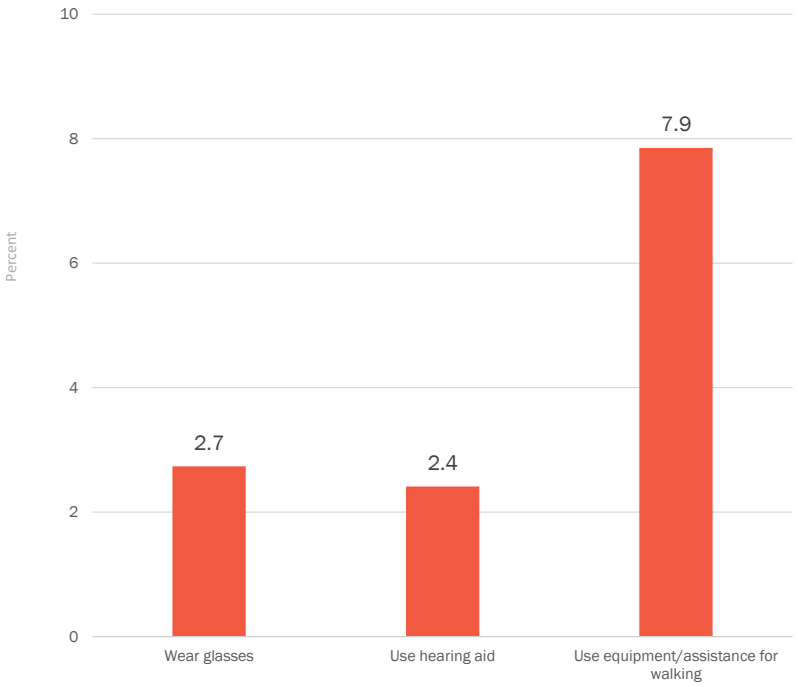
Percentage of children age 5-17 years with functional difficulty in at least one domain

Divisional Data on Child Functioning

Division	2-4 years	5-17 years	2-17 years
National	**3**	**8**	**7**
Barishal	9	21	19
Chattogram	1	10	9
Dhaka	4	5	5
Khulna	2	4	4
Mymensingh	6	18	16
Rajshahi	2	12	10
Rangpur	2	3	3
Sylhet	1	2	2

Percentage of children age 2–17 years with functional difficulty in at least one domain, by region

Children who use Assistive Devices & have Functional Difficulties



Percentage of children age 2-17 years with difficulties seeing when wearing glasses among those who wear glasses, percentage of children age 2-17 years with difficulties hearing when using a hearing aid among those who use a hearing aid, and percentage of children age 2-17 years with difficulties walking when using equipment or receiving assistance among those who use equipment or receive assistance walking

The Bangladesh Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS) was carried out in 2019 by the Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics as part of the global MICS programme. Technical and financial support was also provided by the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF).

The objective of this snapshot is to disseminate selected findings from the Bangladesh MICS 2019 related to Child Functioning. Data from this snapshot can be found in tables EQ1.1, EQ1.2, and EQ1.3.

Further statistical snapshots and the Survey Findings Report for this and other surveys are available on mics.unicef.org/surveys.